#4

ALL NEW!

ARCHIE®

MARK WAID
ANNIE WU

Archie COMICS

#LIPSTICKINCIDENT REVEALED

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SHAZAAKK

!

MAYBE *ACOUSTIC* TODAY.

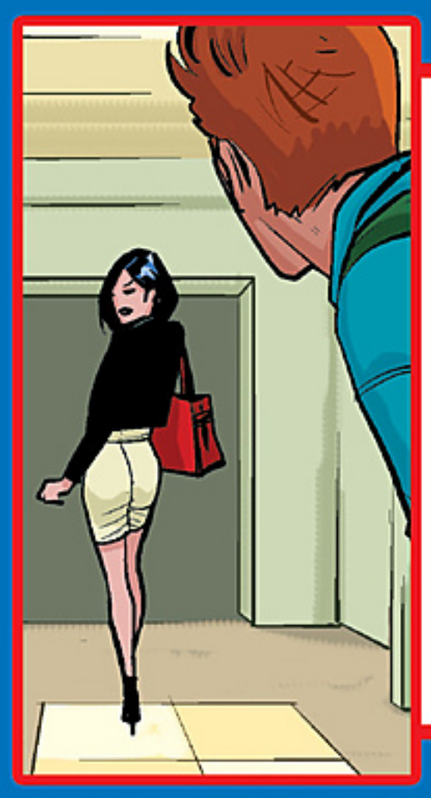
COM-O-*DEE*.

I'M A RIOT. JUST ASK *WEATHER-BEE*.

I APOLOGIZE USING THAT WHICH MEANS THE MOST TO ME: *FOOD*.

WANT HALF?

ARCHIE®



PREVIOUSLY in the TOWN OF RIVERDALE...

The new student, rich socialite **Veronica Lodge**, has managed to wrap **Archie** around her carefully manicured finger, and he's helpless to her whims. **Jughead**'s tired of watching his best friend being led around like a lovesick puppy, but he's going to need some reinforcements if he's going to help Archie get over his crush. **Betty**'s onboard to help out, but first she and Archie need to face their past and address what caused their falling out to begin with…

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CHAPTER ONE: YES, OF COURSE WE WANT TO HEAR ABOUT IT. OBVIOUSLY.

BETTY AND I WERE... SHE WAS...

...THERE AREN'T ***WORDS.*** WE DID ***EVERYTHING*** TOGETHER. INSEPARABLE SINCE ***CHILDHOOD.***

I KNEW HER BETTER THAN HER ***BROTHER*** DID, HER ***MOM...ANYBODY.***

"UNTIL THE FOURTH OF JULY."

WE'RE NOT SUPPOSED TO BE UP HERE.

BEST VIEW IN ***TOWN.*** I'LL RISK IT.

"THAT'S WHEN EVERYTHING STARTED TO ***CHANGE.***"

GOO-BAR

WHAT?

WHAT'D I SAY?

YES. I KNOW. I OVER-REACTED. IT'S JUST...

...JUGHEAD ***REMINDED*** ME OF SOMETHING. HE DIDN'T MEAN TO, BUT HE DID, AND NOW IT'S GONNA BE STUCK IN MY ***HEAD*** THE REST OF THE DAY.

"IT" = THE THING THAT BROKE UP BETTY AND ME.

"IT" = THE ***LIPSTICK INCIDENT.***

...

YOU WANT TO ***HEAR*** ABOUT IT?

RACE YOU TO POP'S.

DON'T FALL.

YOU SAY THAT EVERY TIME. YOU DON'T HAVE TO KEEP--

BAE!

41

OOF!

WHAT ARE WE, SEVEN?

I KNOW. WE EVER GOING TO GROW UP?

NOT IF I CAN HELP IT.

PROMISE ME WE'LL ALWAYS STAY THIS WAY.

PROMISE ME YOU'LL STAY THE SAME.

HAVE WE MET? I HAVEN'T CHANGED **SOCKS** SINCE THAT TIME WE GOT LOST IN THE **MARSH.**

EEEW. THAT WAS **FOURTH GRADE.**

HERE, I'LL PROVE IT.

NO!

I'LL DO IT--!

DON'T! DON'T TAKE OFF YOUR SHOES! MY HAZMAT SUIT IS AT THE CLEANERS! PLEEEASE!

YOU CRAZY.

WHY WOULD I WANT **ANYTHING** TO BE DIFFERENT?

I HAVE GOOD FRIENDS, I LIKE MY SCHOOL, I'M COMFORT-ABLE...

...EVERYTHING IS **PERFECT.**

WANT *HALF?* AWFUL *GOOEY.*

IF ONLY THEY COULD HAVE *ALERTED* US SOME WAY.

THAT *GOO-BARS* ARE *GOOEY.*

MAYBE A *WARNING* ON THE *WRAPPER.*

SOME PIECE OF *WRITING* ABOUT *GOO* AND *BARS.*

ALL RIGHT! IT WAS DUMB TO SAY.

YOU'VE SAID DUMBER.

HA.

AAH! *ANTS!*

I GOT 'EM, TOO! WASH UP! *HURRY!*

ONE SIDE!

DID YOU *SEE?*

FILTHY! LIKE MY TWO-YEAR-OLD *BROTHER!*

I WONDER IF *SHE* WEARS A DIAPER.

WHAT WAS IN HER *HAIR,* ANYWAY? IT LOOKED LIKE--

TALKING ABOUT *BETTY?*

AR-CHIE! *HIII!*

BECAUSE I'D HATE TO SEE ANYONE MAKE *FUN* OF HER. WHEN YOU GET TO *KNOW* HER, SHE'S REALLY *AMAZING.*

WE WOULDN'T.

MAKE *FUN* OF HER. EVER.

COOL. SEEYA.

THIS IS *AWFUL.* THE LAST THING I WANT TO DO IS MAKE *ARCHIE* MAD.

ME, TOO. HE'S SO POPULAR.

WE HAVE TO *FIX* THIS.

HOW?

BETTY!

WANT TO *HANG OUT* SOME TIME?

YEAH! WANT TO?

CHAPTER TWO: Lizzie

BETTY, YOU'RE ***WEIRD.*** GIRLS AREN'T ***GEARHEADS.***

EXCUSE ME? GIRLS ARE WHATEVER WE ***WANT*** TO BE.

ABSOLUTELY, OF ***COURSE,*** BUT NOT ***THAT.*** AND THIS ***MUSIC*** SOUNDS LIKE MY ***DAD'S.***

I LIKE IT. THE LYRICS ARE REALLY--

LYRICS ARE ***STUPID.***

HEY! ***I*** WRITE LYRICS!

ALL I'M ***SAYING*** IS, MUSIC NEEDS TO ***SOUND*** GOOD. NOW CAN WE GO BACK TO HELPING ***BETTY,*** PLEASE?

HELPING?

NOBODY WANTS TO ***SAY*** THIS TO YOUR ***FACE,*** BUT YOUR ***NAME*** HAS GOT TO ***GO.*** "BETTY" SOUNDS LIKE SOMEBODY'S ***DEAD GRANDMOTHER.***

SHEILA!

DON'T MIND HER. NO FILTER. BUT IT DOES SOUND, LIKE, ***HISTORICAL.*** WHAT'S BETTY ***SHORT*** FOR? BETTINA? BETTERIA?

ELIZABETH.

WE'LL CALL YOU ***LIZZIE!***

STOP!

SHUT!

UP!

IS THERE *ANYTHING* YOU *LIKE* ABOUT ME?

LOVE YOUR *NAME,* LIZZIE.

IT *IS* PERFECT. LIZZIE COOPER. *AND* YOU'RE SO *PRETTY!* HONEST! YOU JUST NEED TO LEARN HOW TO...

WHAT?

...*WEAR* IT.

"*MALL UP,* GIRLS."

EYEBR
THREADING

STOP YANKING!

HEY, *ROUSEY,* DROP IT *DOWN!*

GHUU*AAHH--!*

Oh, MY GOD, SHE'S LIKE A *HORMONE COCKTAIL!*

HOTNESS, *WAIT UP!*

"HOTNESS."

LIZZIE, *OWN IT.* I *GET* IT'S WEIRD HOW BOYS *LOOK* AT YOU DIFFERENT THAN THEY USED TO, BUT *ENJOY!*

SO THEY'RE STARING AT YOU. YOU'RE STARING RIGHT BACK AT THEM. IT'S ALL GOOD. YES?

YES. *NO.* I DON'T *KNOW.*

"GIRLS ARE WHATEVER WE *WANT* TO BE."

BE *BOLD.*

2

SHE'D LOVE TO! PICK HER UP AT *ELEVEN!*

WHO IS THIS?

HANG UP HANG UP *HANG UP!*

IT'S ARCHIE. 'SEC.

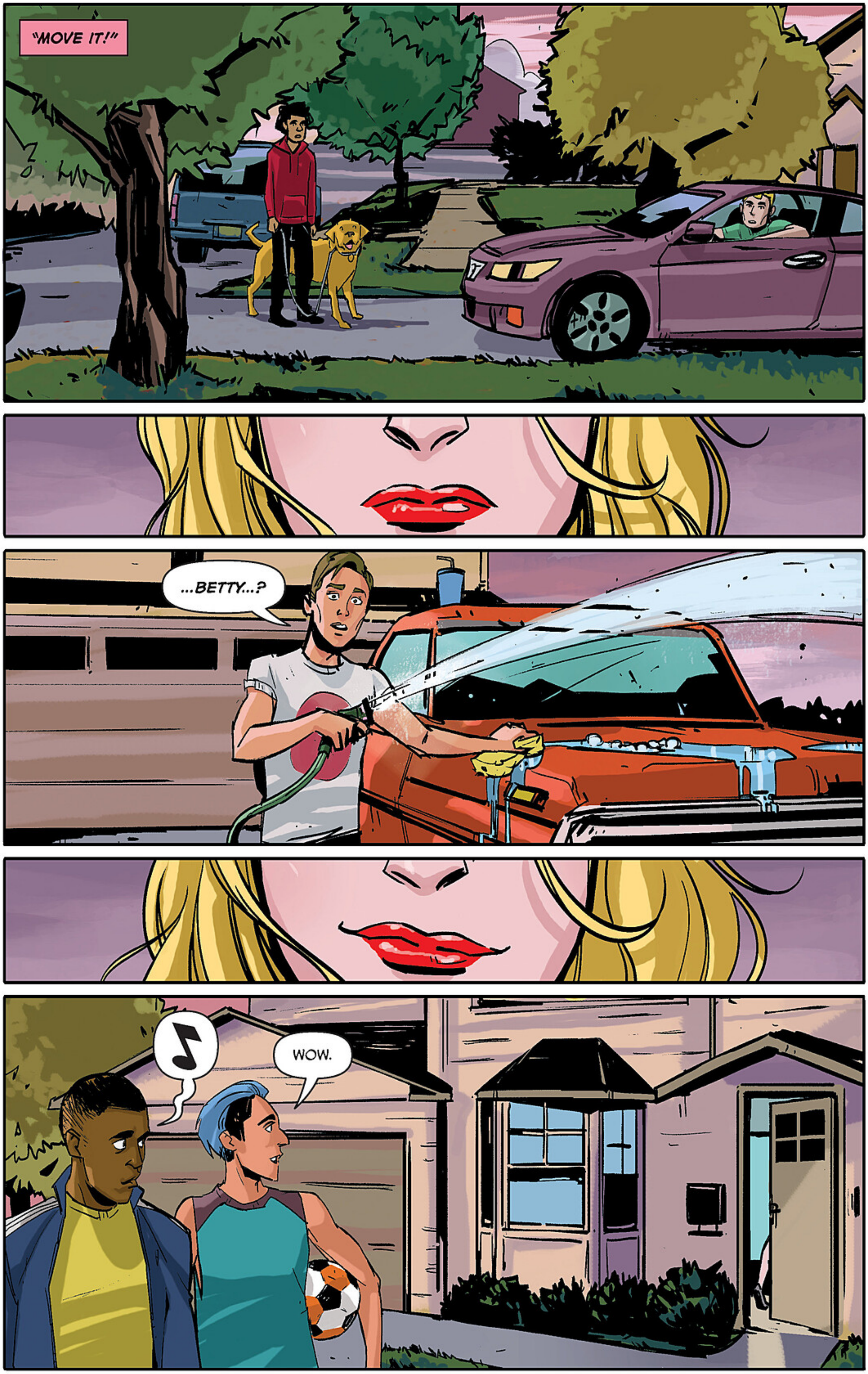
♫--

BETTS? MIDNIGHT HORROR MOVIE. WANNA GO?

RED ALERT! WE HAVE TO PUNCH THIS MAKEOVER INTO *FIFTH!* YOU HAVE A *DATE!*

THAT'S *DUMB.* WE'VE BEEN GOING OUT SINCE *KINDERGARTEN.*

NOT *"GOING OUT"* GOING OUT! *TRUST US!* MOVE IT!


"MOVE IT!"
...BETTY...?
WOW.

READY TO **ROLL,** PAL.

COME GET ME, ARCHIE.

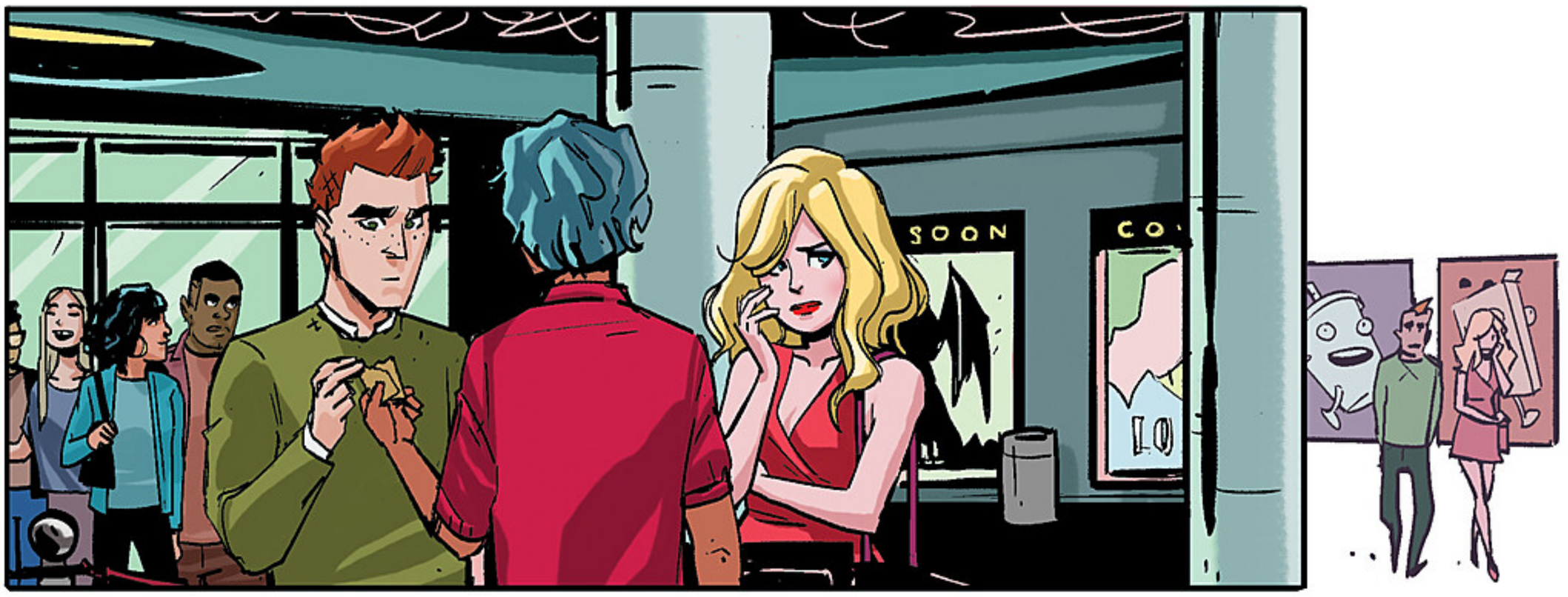
YOUR **LEG** BROKEN? YOU'RE RIGHT NEXT **DOOR.** JUST COME **OUT.**

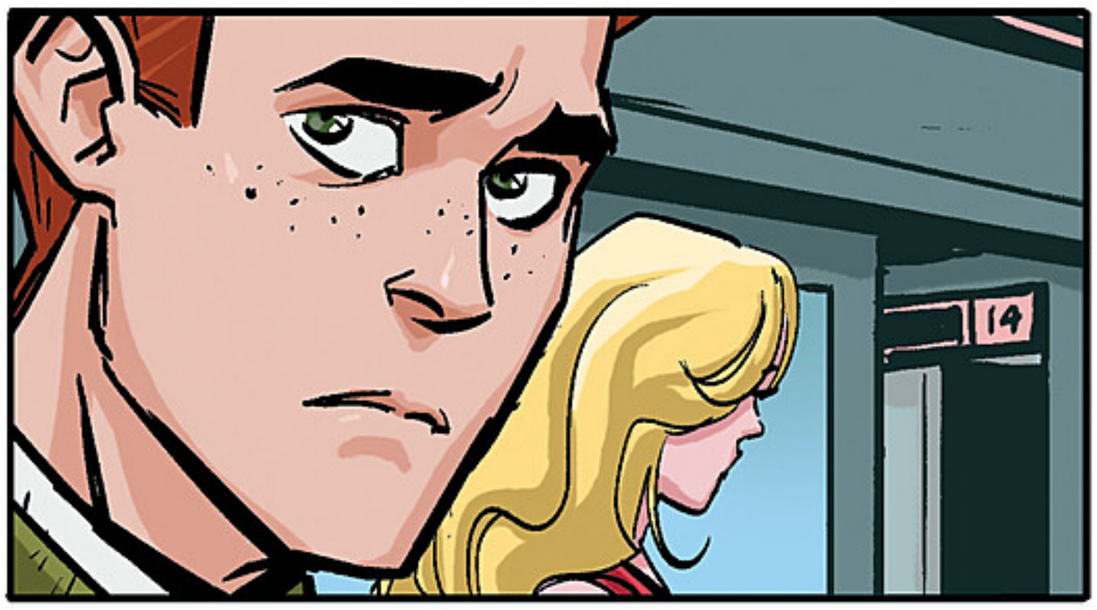
COME **GET** ME, ARCHIE.

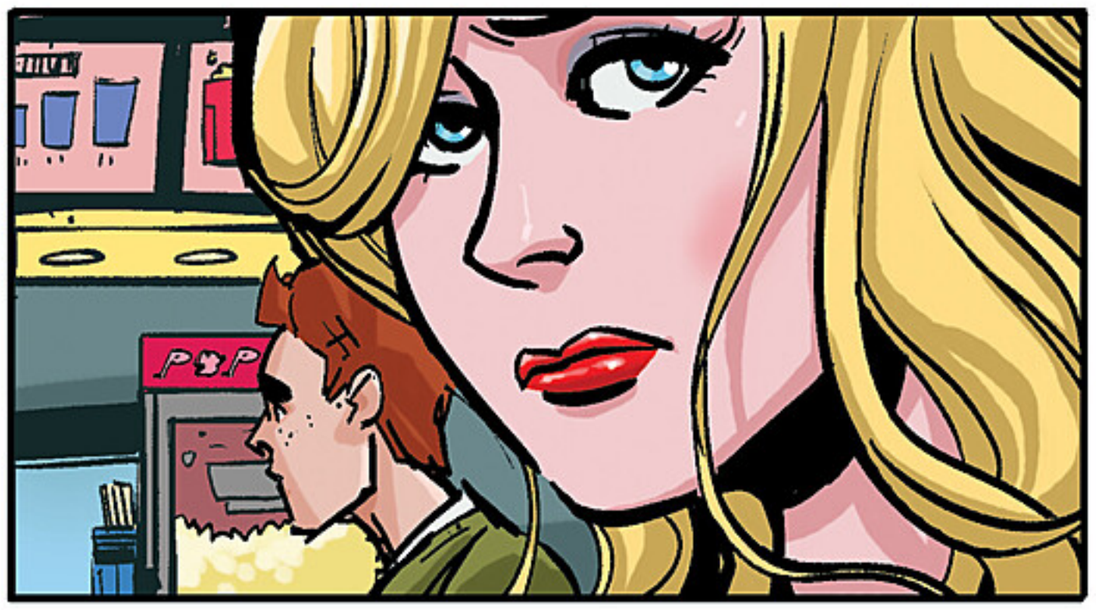
♪ BING-BONG-ONGG ♪

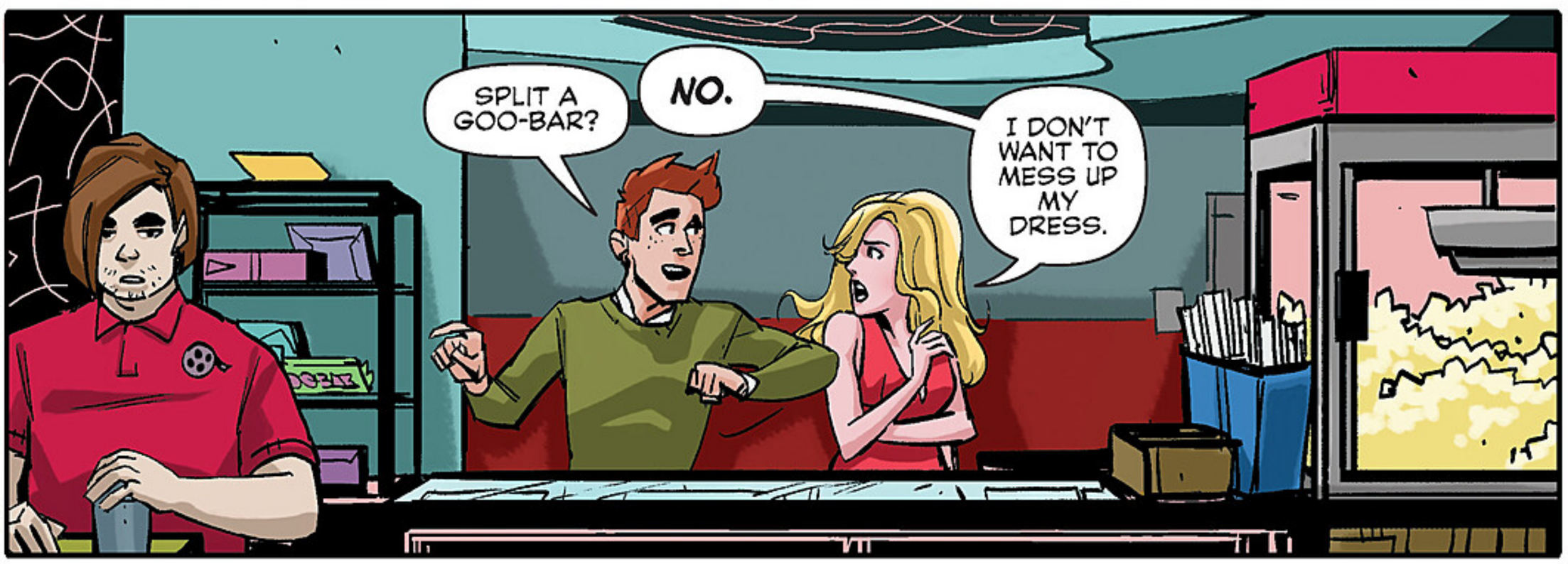
HELLO, ARCHIE.

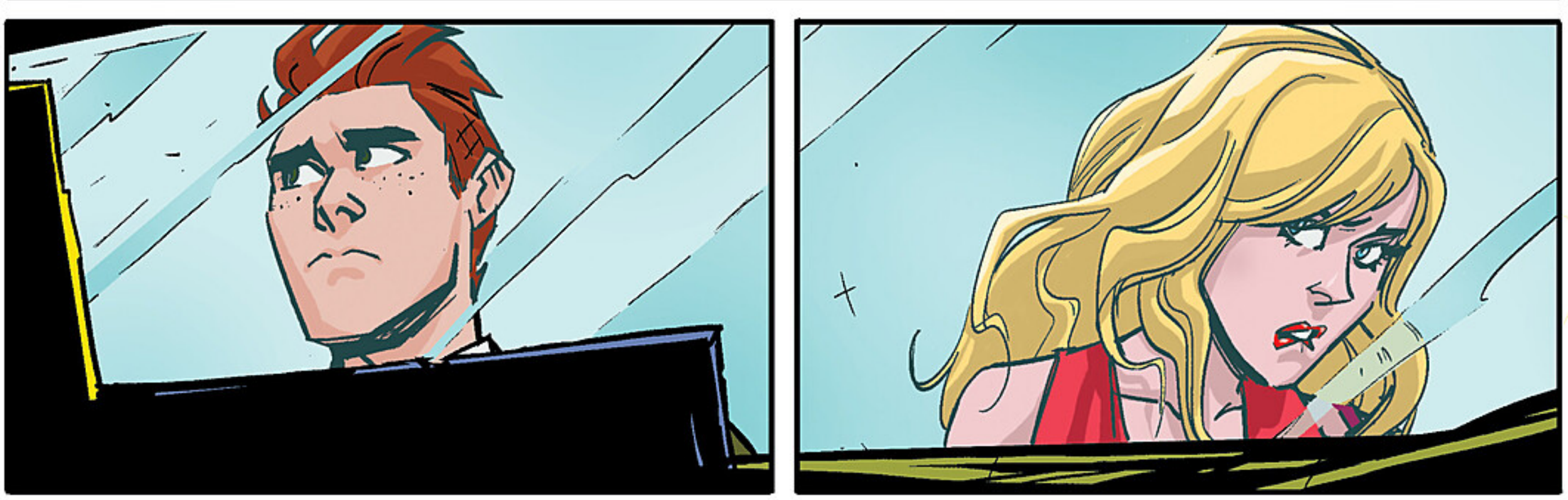
CHAPTER THREE: #LIPSTICKINCIDENT



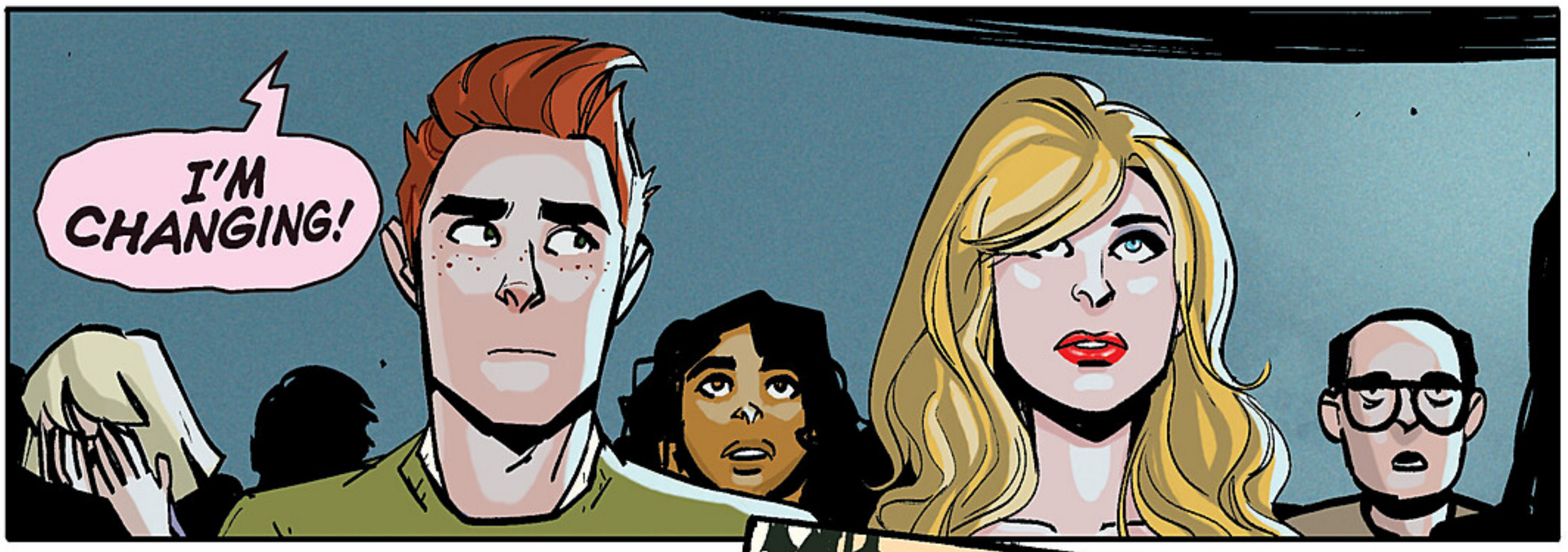








ARGH!!


I'M CHANGING!

CHAAAANGINNNNG!!

CREATURE DOUBLE FEATURE

BETTY, WAIT!

WHY? WHY ARE YOU BEING SO *WEIRD* ALL OF A SUDDEN?

I'M WEIRD? LOOK AT *YOU!*

ARCHIE!

THAT'S NOT WHAT I--

WHAT'S WRONG WITH ME?

NOTHING!

I *KNOW* YOU LOOK AT GIRLS DRESSED UP *JUST LIKE THIS!*

SOMETIMES! I DON'T MEAN TO! IT'S JUST THAT *THEY'RE--*

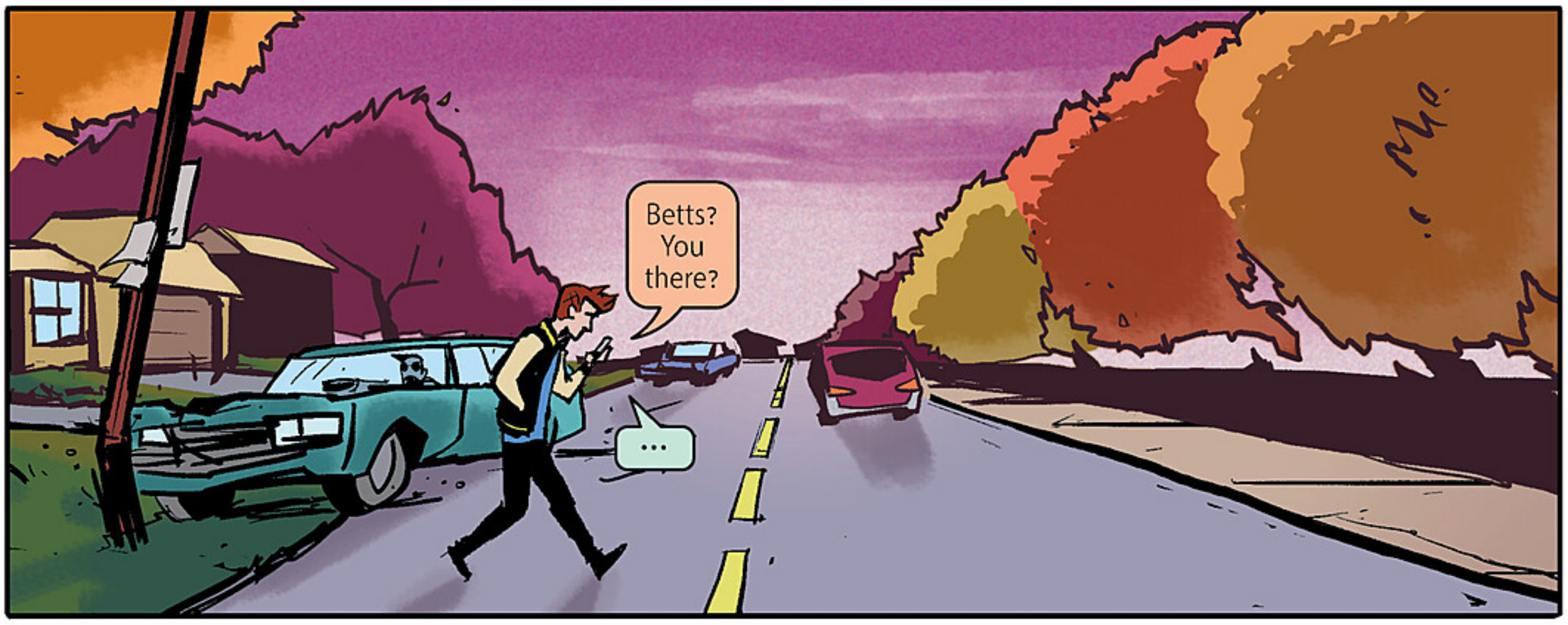
THEY'RE *WHAT?*

WE'RE TALKING ABOUT *YOU,* OKAY?

THIS! *THIS* IS THE CRAP THAT DOESN'T *BELONG* ON YOU! WHERE'S THE BETTY I *KNOW?*

FUNNY.

YOU'RE STILL YOU.


Betts? You there?
...

...

...

...

#LIPSTICKINCIDENT.

WE HAVEN'T SAID A WORD TO ONE ANOTHER SINCE.

I WAS JUST TRYING TO KEEP A ***PROMISE.***

I MISS HER.

...

I ALSO MISS MY ***DRUMMER,*** APPARENTLY.

GUESS HE ***BAILED*** FOR THE DAY. OH, WELL...SO MUCH FOR BAND PRACTICE.

THAT'S A SHAME.

I'D ***LOVE*** TO HEAR YOU PLAY.

I MISS BETTY.

HELLO, ***VERONICA.***

DID I HEAR THAT RIGHT?

IS HE MAKING UP A SONG CALLED "*VERONICA*"?

EITHER THAT, OR A BUS IS RUNNING OVER A BAGPIPE.

DON'T SWEAT IT. HAVE CONFIDENCE. WE'RE HERE TO DISCUSS OUR INFALLIBLE *ANTI-VERONICA PLAN.*

AND FOR THE RECORD...

...WE DON'T NEED *REGGIE MANTLE'S* HELP.

I WOULDN'T BE SO SURE ABOUT THAT...

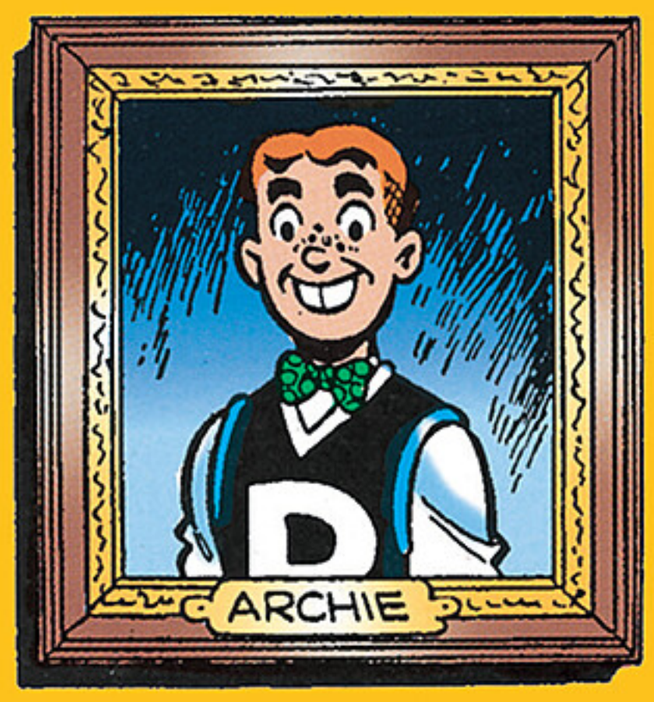
NEXT

REGGIE VS. Veronica!

AN INTRODUCTION TO...

Classic Archie®

by MARK WAID



WHO'S USING WATER?

There are stories in which Archie Andrews is incredibly sharp and clever, and there are stories in which you'd swear he needs to take off his shoes in order to count past ten.

Guess which kind you're about to read.

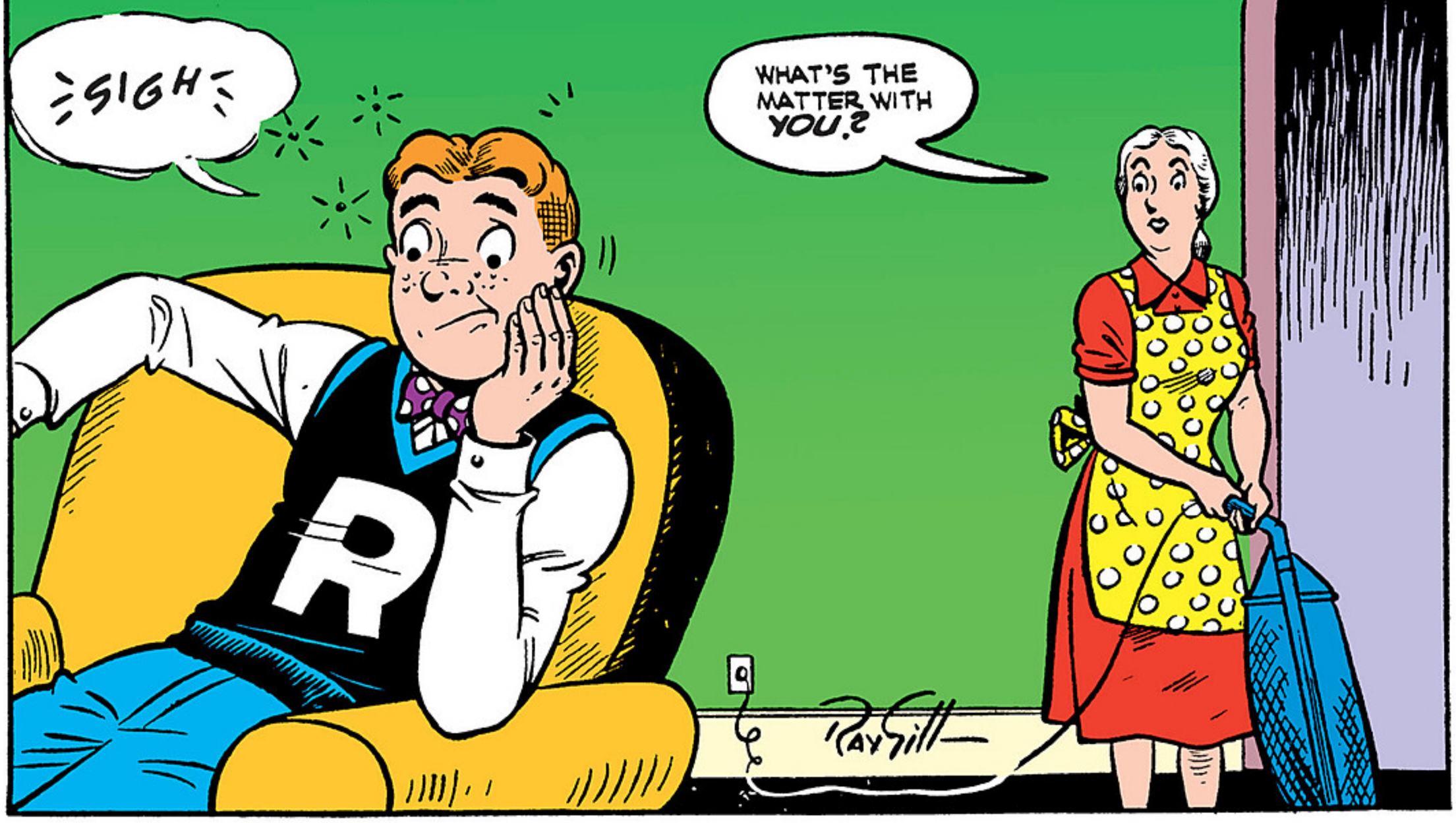
Submitted for your enjoyment, "The Great Lover" from *Archie Comics* #36, 1949. Archie "feels like dating someone tonight," but Veronica's tied up with a debutante ball or shopping for poodle skirts or listening to Abbott and Costello on the Crosley or playing with tops or whatever the heck it is that kids did for entertainment back before they invented *Tosh.0*. At his mother's suggestion, he calls up Betty, who's "like a sister to him," he dresses down in the exact same clothes that, my hand to God, I am wearing this very second as I write this, and hijinks ensue.

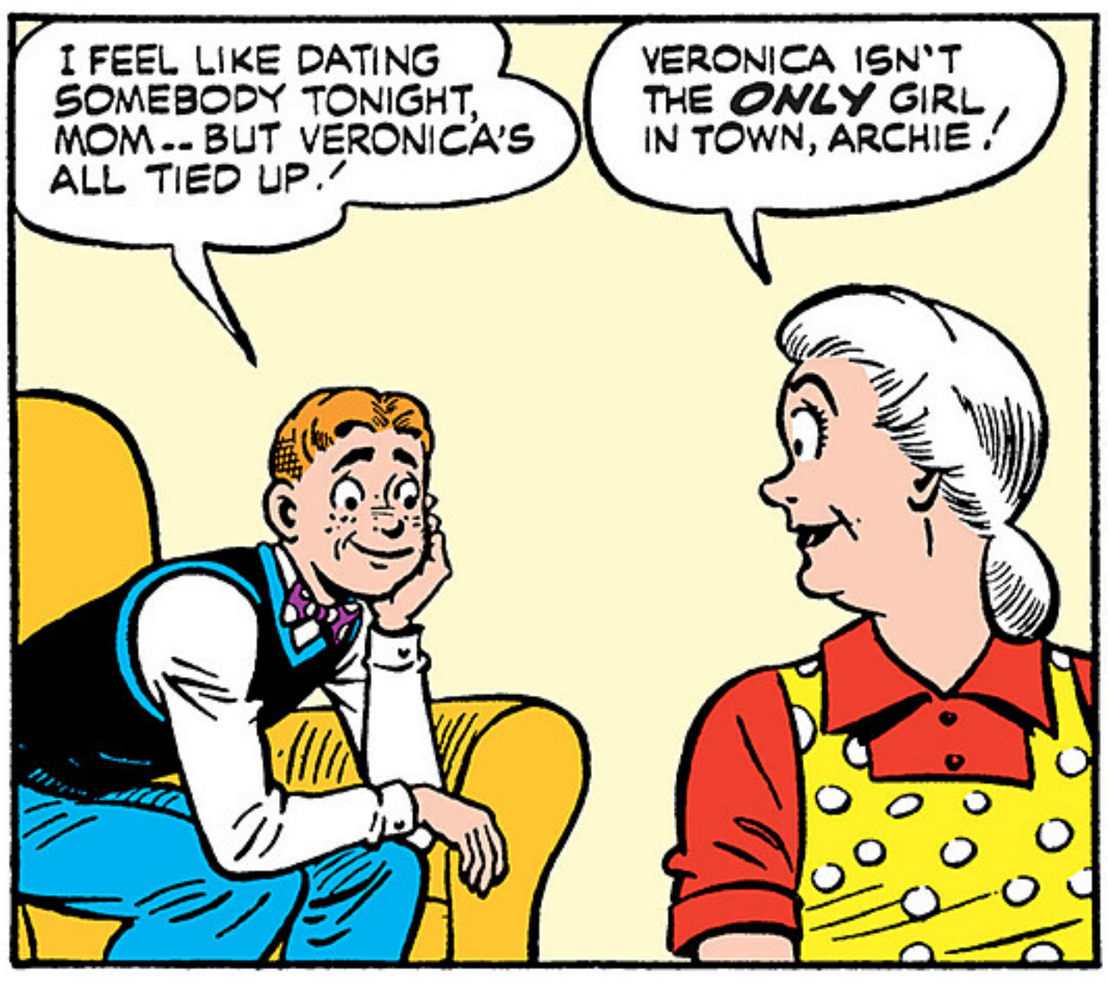
I pointed this out last issue and it bears repeating: in the earliest days of the *Archie* series, Betty wasn't so much Veronica's rival as the underdog who was secretly carrying a torch for the boy with the tic-tac-toe sideburns. That immediately makes everyone in the triangle more likeable; Betty and Veronica aren't catfighting over a boy, and that boy isn't playing two girls off one another like some sort of demented puppeteer. That's not a slam on these earlier stories. Most of them were funnier and more charming than anything I could ever hope to write today, but many of them were of an era, hard to fold into a 2015 reinvention without being sexist or making these girls simply into prizes to be won.

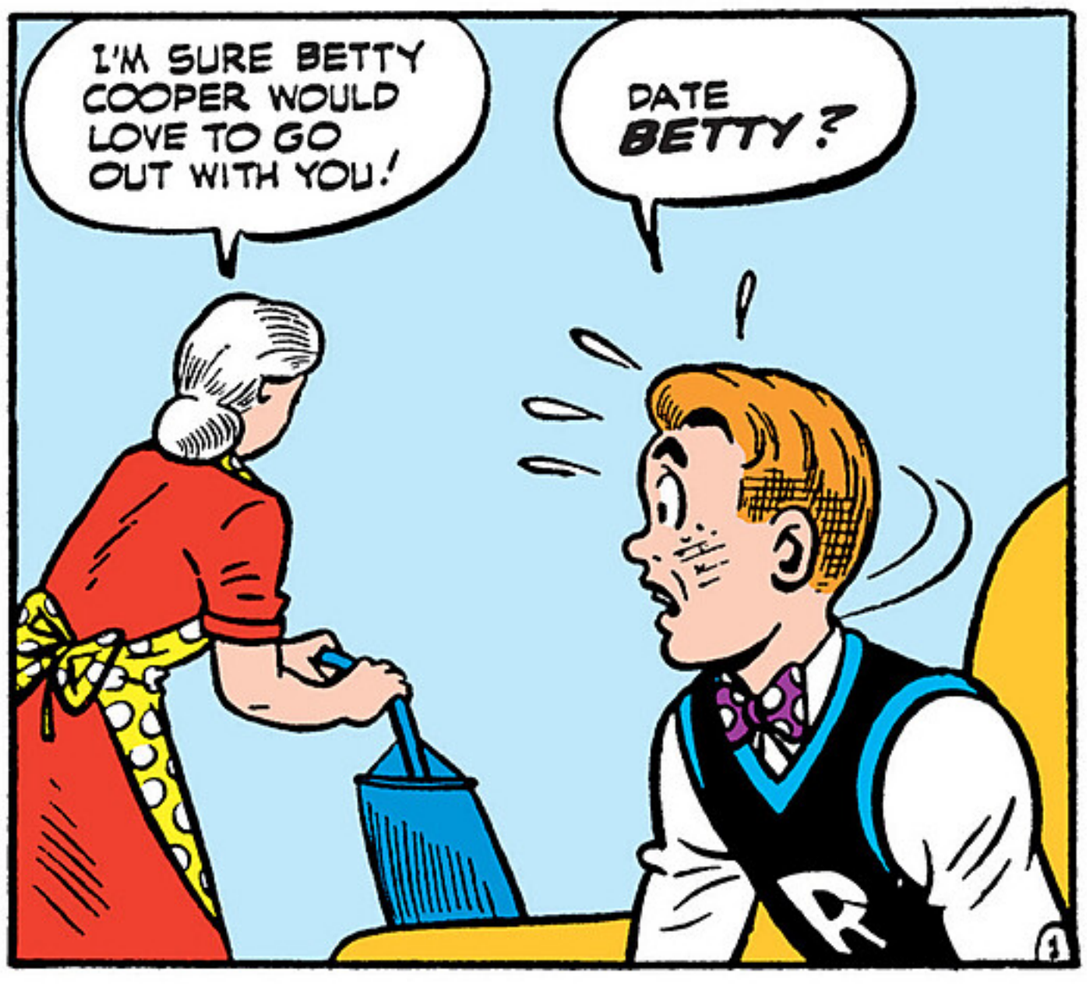
Escaping that, "The Great Lover," other than how it relies on the gimmick of a "hope chest"— a collection of linens and fine clothes and silverware and other things that unmarried girls would save for the day they'd finally be wed, and something you've never heard of because you were born after 1970— still holds up today, I would argue. Relationships are just as confusing as ever, dating's still a delightful morass of mismatched expectations and misread signals, and everyone knows the heartbreak of getting spiffed up for a night of hot romance only to end up staring across the couch at someone who, as it turns out, thinks of you with the same degree of passion as they do their Basset Hound or their iPhone. Speaking personally, I never went out with someone who brought a book (or a flashlight, as one does), but I did once go on a blind date with a woman who brought magazines in case she got bored, so it's entirely possible my heart goes out a little extra-strongly to Betty this month.

Archie

THE GREAT LOVER







WHY NOT? SHE'S A LOVELY GIRL.!

OH, SURE--BUT WE DON'T THINK OF EACH OTHER LIKE THAT--WE'RE JUST GOOD FRIENDS.!

BETTY'S LIKE A *SISTER* TO ME, MOM!

THEN SHOW SOME *BROTHERLY* LOVE, FOR HEAVEN'S SAKE.!

CALL THE GIRL UP.! MAKE A DATE WITH HER.! WHO KNOWS.. YOU MIGHT EVEN *ENJOY* HER COMPANY.!

?

MAYBE MOM'S RIGHT..

NO HARM IN TRYING, ANYWAY.!

THIS IS ARCHIE! DOING ANYTHING TONIGHT, KEED?

ER--NO--BUT YOU MUST HAVE THE *WRONG* NUMBER, ARCHIE--THIS IS *BETTY COOPER* SPEAKING.!

I KNOW.! IF YOU'RE NOT DOING ANYTHING TONIGHT, I'LL BE OVER AT EIGHT.!

HELLO, BETTY..

BETTY?

SHE DOESN'T ANSWER, MOM.' WE MUST HAVE BEEN CUT OFF!

OH, MOTHER.. I JUST HAD THE MOST WONDERFUL *DREAM*.!

I DREAMT *ARCHIE* CALLED ME, AND..

BUT YOU WERE JUST TALKING TO HIM, DEAR! I HEARD YOU MENTION HIS NAME.!

THEN HE *IS* COMING.!

QUICK, MOTHER.! WHERE ARE THE "*MAN KILLER*" BATH SALTS I'VE BEEN SAVING?

IN THE CLOSET, DEAR.!

I HOPE YOU DON'T THINK A FEW DROPS OF THAT STUFF IN YOUR BATH WATER IS GOING TO HELP GET YOUR **MAN** FOR YOU.!

WHO'S USING *WATER*?

LATER--

LA-LA ♫ ♪ LA-LAA.. .'

WOULD YOU IRON A FEW THINGS FOR ME, MOM?

OF COURSE, DEAR .. BRING THEM HERE WHILE THE IRON IS HOT.'

REET, SWEET.'

HERE Y'ARE, MOM.'

GOOD **GRIEF**, BETTY.' ARE YOU GOING TO NEED ALL THAT STUFF FOR ***TONIGHT***?

OH, **NO**.' I'M STARTING TO WORK ON MY ***HOPE CHEST*** AGAIN.' =SIGH=

RIVEROAK

HOPE CHEST

THIS IS WHAT I'M WEARING-- LIKE IT MOTHER?

WHY, THAT'S YOUR BEST FORMAL.' WHERE ON EARTH IS ARCHIE TAKING YOU?

NO PLACE.' WE'RE STAYING HOME.'

?

ARCHIEKINS IS SUCH A HANDSOME *DEBONAIR* DRESSER --

I WANT TO LOOK JUST *RIGHT* FOR HIM!

RRINGG! RRINGG!

BETTY!--YOUR *DEBONAIR DRESSER* IS HERE!

LATER--

(SNIF-SNIF) WHAT'S THAT FUNNY SMELL?

THAT'S *PERFUME* YOU **DOPE**!

SAY, I'M GLAD WE'RE ALONE WITH NO ONE TO BOTHER US, BETTY.

YOU **ARE**, ARCHIE *(SIGH)*? WHY?

'CAUSE I CAN FINISH THIS BOOK I'VE STARTED.

I'LL **FIX** HIM!--IF I CAN ONLY GET MY FOOT UNDER THAT LAMP CORD--

THERE!

HEY. WHAT HAPPENED TO THE **LIGHTS**-?

HOLD ME, ♪♪ ARCHIE-- I'M **SCARED!** ♫

DON'T WORRY, BETTY--

I CAME PREPARED FOR **ANY** EMERGENCY.

BOY, THIS FIRE-PLACE, AND THIS DARK ROOM DOES SOMETHING TO ME, BETTY.

AT LAST HE'S WEAKENING.

WHAT, ♪♪ ARCHIE?

MAKIN' ME **SLEEPY.** (YAWN) THINK I'LL GO HOME AN' HIT THE HAY.

THE URGE TO KILL.

ER..I WOULD.. ER.. IF I COULD ASK YOU FOR SOMETHING BEFORE I SAY GOOD NIGHT, BETTY?

OH, ♡ ARCHIE ♡.

I HOPE YOU DON'T THINK I'M BEIN' FRESH, BETTY, BUT.. BUT...

YES, ARCHIE.. YES?

BUT WOULD YOU LET ME HAVE A PIECE OF YOUR MOM'S SWELL *CUSTARD PIE*?

JUST A *LITTLE* PIECE WILL DO, BETTY..

OH, I'LL DO BETTER THAN *THAT*, ARCHIEKINS..♪

YOU CAN HAVE THE *WHOLE PIE*!

SPLAT

LATER--

DON'T TELL ME YOU'RE STILL WORKING ON YOUR HOPE CHEST, DEAR!

I'LL BE FINISHED IN A SECOND, MOTHER..

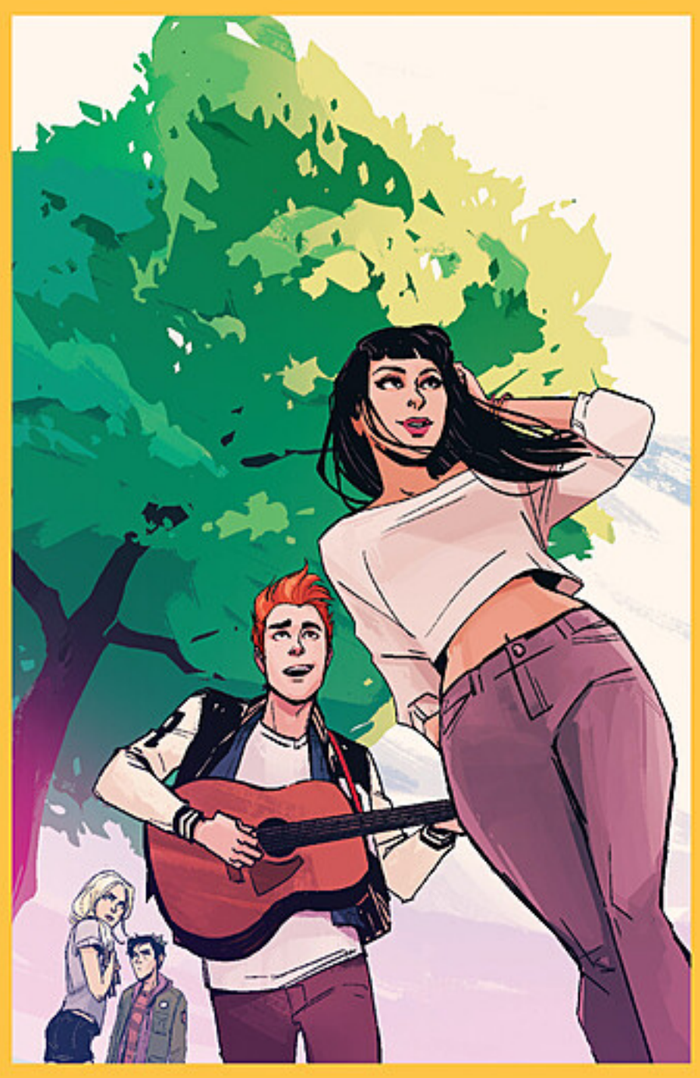
..FOR *GOOD*.!

HOPELESS CHEST

The End.

COVER GALLERY

ARCHIE #4



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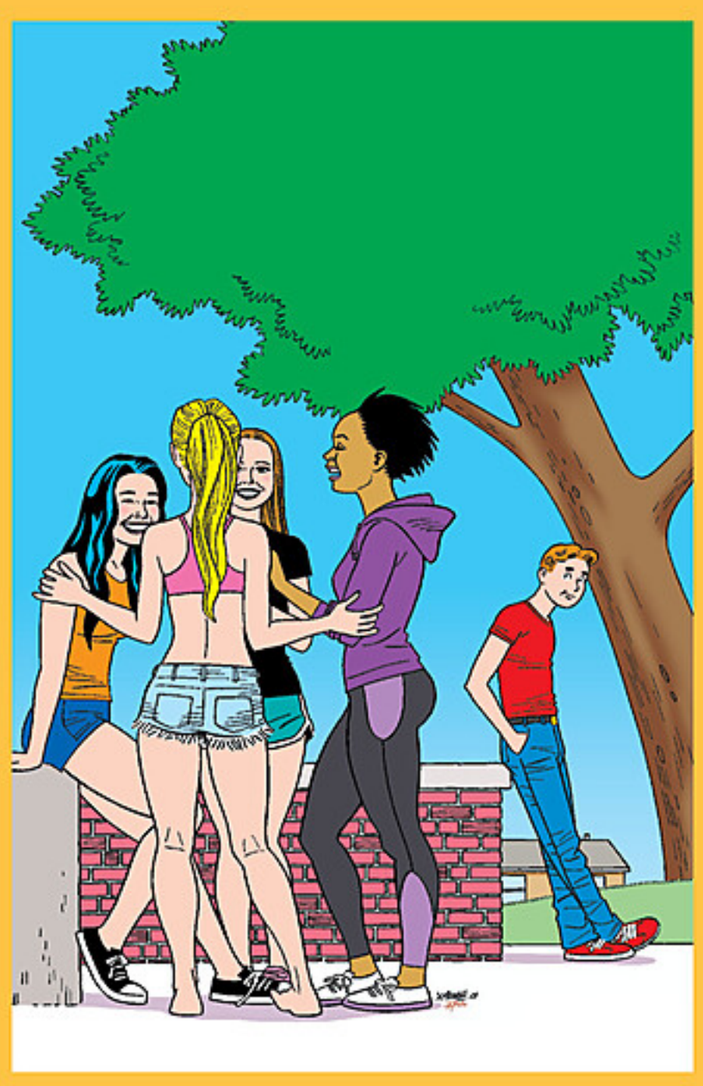
MAHMUD ASRAR

FRANCESCO FRANCAVILLA



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